The Mountainside

A Publication of the Coolfont Mountainside Association

Summer, 2002 Volume 4 Issue 7

NEW!! www.coolfontmountainside.org

Annual Meeting Begins New Year for CMA

By Jackson Bain

A large, congenial crowd of Coolfont Mountainside Association members gathered in the newly renovated Treetops Lodge for the 2002 Annual Meeting and election of officers.

Richard Kaufman was re-elected to serve another term, and he was joined by Jackson Bain and Jim Chiriaco. All three candidates were unopposed and were elected by acclimation.

Retiring from the Board after two year terms were long time residents Lon Dring and Joan Hash. Both were praised for their hard work and contributions. The good news for CMA is that Lon will stay on as Chair of the Roads Committee to complete the work he began during his tenure. Please note the attached page for all of the 2002-2003 Committee Chairs and Board members names and telephone numbers. This page can be inserted into your new (blue cover) 2002 Membership Directory, replacing the old board / committee list.

The annual meeting saw the 2002 budget approved, which due to computer problems had to be projected on a large screen. The version of the budget sent earlier to the membership was incorrect, and the approved budget is enclosed in this newsletter for your review.

During the meeting, a number of issues were discussed, including the restoration of the CMA tennis courts. With four courts to restore, the CMA board will depend on the views of the membership on how best to address the problem. Marie Barrett distributed a survey to determine those views, and the results will guide the board to a solution. Some possibilities include restoration of two of the courts, while turning the remaining two courts into courts for other sports, such as basketball and/or shuffleboard.

Security patrols were also an issue, and new efforts will be made to track the guard's patrols.

In other business, Lon Dring reported on road repairs and repaving projects to be scheduled in the coming year, and reviewed the importance of keeping the ditches and culverts clear of debris and leaves to protect the roads. A professional survey is being planned to determine the best ways to prevent erosion on the roads.

President Richard Kaufman reviewed the CMA accomplishments for the past year, including the addition of the "T" section and the construction of the new CMA office and pool bath / changing building.

BOARD MEETINGS and POTLUCK DINNER SCHEDULE

September 21:
***Board*: 10:00 a.m.**
CMA Office

***Potluck*: 7:00 p.m.**
BARN

October 19:

***Board:* 10:00 a.m.**
CMA Office

***Potluck:* 7:00 p.m.**
BARN

November 9:

***Board:* 10:00 a.m.**
Place to be determined

Potluck:
7:00 p.m.
Place to be determined

December 14:

***Board:* 10:00 a.m.**
Place to be determined

***Potluck:* 7:00 p.m.**
Place to be determined

Jaunary 11:

***Board:* 10:00 a.m.**
Place to be determined

***Potluck:* 7:00 p.m.**
Place to be determined

COME TO THE CMA BOARD MEETINGS AND THE POTLUCK DINNERS!

Want to Know What's Going On Faster?

If you would like to receive notification of monthly board meetings, potlucks and other CMA information via e-mail, please send your e-mail address to:

Joan Bradfield, CMA Secretary at :

jbradfield1@juno.com.

HOST A POTLUCK OR BOARD MEETING!

Joan Bradfield, board liaison to the Social Committee, is looking for hosts for CMA's Board meetings and / or Potluck Dinners!
Please let Joan know if you would be able to pitch in and help with hosting!

See accompanying article in this issue for details!
jbradfield1@juno.com
or:
(301) 984-9657

Website UPDATE:
www.coolfontmountainside.org
Makes its debut!

The board approved a motion to acquire the Internet domain **coolfontmountainside.org**. This will allow the CMA website to be moved to a commercial web hosting company, without those pop-up ads. This move will also allow the webmaster, Bob Borchers, to set up mailing lists for the membership that do not disclose the individual email addresses of the recipients. Since our web hosting company POWWEB.COM includes the ability to configure up to 250 email boxes and forwarding addresses, any CMA member can request an address of the form <yourname@coolfontmountainside.org>, which will be programmed to forward to your personal email address, for an additional measure of security in making sure your email address does not find its way in to the hands of the evil "spammers".

The mountainside web page will now move to:

<www.coolfontmountainside.org>

as soon as the new name propagates across the net, certainly before you read this. The old web address will contain a pointer to the new address for a few months so folks can adjust their "favorites" folder in their web browser.
Robert R. Borchers
CMA Webmaster



Saturday, August 10: The CMA Board holds the first board meeting inside our new association office, adjacent to the swimming pool. It also features two complete bath / changing rooms. Pictured left to right are Jim Chiriaco, Paul Kagen, Elmer Broxson, Joan Bradfield, Richard Kaufman and Jackson Bain.

Mountainside Security and Mail: News from Board Member Jim Chiriaco

By Jim Chiriaco

Security Update:
An informal audit of the security operations was conducted. CMA has an existing written agreement with CRI (Coolfont Resort) to police the properties. A security officer is making rounds of some of the Coolfont Mountainside Association properties from 10 p.m. until the following morning. There is only partial documentation that reflects this information. For a temporary resolution, CMA has decided to create our own Security Report Form to ensure that all of the Coolfont Mountainside Association properties are at least driven by and checked throughout the night until the morning 7 days a week. There will be some security tips posted on the CMA website for your information as provided by Wackenhut Security Inc.

Mailbox Update:
We have determined that there are a number of CMA members who are utilizing the mailboxes by the barn and there are various other mailboxes not being used. The mailboxes not being used will be reassigned to those members who are interested in receiving mail delivery on the mountainside. We are in the process of producing an updated list of residences to the Post Office based on the new number and street address system that has designated by the county Fire and Rescue organization. Mail delivery will then be based on this new address, but delivered at the boxes near the barn.

IMPORTANT: EMERGENCY TELEPHONE NUMBERS:

Security Issues on the Mountainside:
Coolfont Front Desk **(304) 258-4500**

Ambulance, Police or Fire Emergencies: **911**

The President's Column

GOALS FOR THE NEW YEAR

All of us should be pleased with the developments on the mountainside over the past year. In addition to completing our new pool house and office facility, we repaired and replaced many sections of our water lines, provided necessary maintenance of the roads, published several issues of the CMA newsletter, made several improvements to our web site, landscaped the area around the entrance to the pool, held a well attended square dance in the barn, and facilitated numerous pot luck dinners and open houses.

We also completed the transfer of the T section. This was a lengthy and difficult process. Under our agreement with the developer (Coolfont Development Corporation) we had the right to require that certain aspects of the development be completed to our satisfaction before we would accept the transfer of ownership of the common lands and roads. We successfully asserted this right and also rejected proposed language in the deed conveying the property that would have compromised the community's authority to preserve the common lands and our ability to restrict the use of our roads.

Recently, a new set of problems has risen regarding the T section. We learned of significant water leakage in the system installed by the developer and of some other problems in that section. Fortunately, the developer was responsible for maintenance of the water lines and other systems in the T section for one year from the transfer of ownership and we gave notice of these problems within the time allowed. The Developer has acknowledged responsibility for the problems and is taking steps to correct them.

(Continued next page)

"MUSICAL BRIDGE TO CHINA" AT COOLFONT

Musicians from China and the U.S. will join at Coolfont Resort August 19-24 to create musical and international harmony. "Musical Bridge to China" will feature musical ensembles from both countries, art objects, lectures on Chinese culture, medicine and feng shui, classes in Chinese art and calligraphy and Chinese tea.

Co-sponsored by the Oriental Cultural Foundation and the Coolfont Foundation, the week-long event will feature musical groups including "Music from China" and "The Sunrise Quartet, along with Coolfont resident Maestro Zuohuang Chen. West Virginia Public Broadcasting will tape the Saturday, August 24 joint musical performance. There is a small fee for most events during the festival, in the form of donations to the Foundation.
CMA homeowners have been asked to donate their homes or spare rooms for the visiting performers and artists. For more information, contact Coolfont Resort at (304) 258-4500.

Coolfont Recreation Committee Conducts Member Survey

Recreation Committee Chair Marie Barrett created and distributed a member survey at the Annual Meeting, asking Coolfont owners about their likes and dislikes, as well as CMA recreation amenities they would like to see added. The survey results were unveiled at the August 10 board meeting, and will guide the board in its decision-making.

23 surveys were returned, making a statistically valid sample for determining homeowner opinion. While your opinion may not be reflected in these highlights, the following reflects the views of the survey participants. Here are Marie's highlights:

POOL: Most homeowners want better maintenance to keep the water clear. Lifeguards need to check swim passes. The new landscaping is much appreciated. The pool itself is appreciated.

TENNIS COURTS: More people would use the courts if in better shape (the courts, not the people). All want some repair of the courts. Most would like to fix up two courts for tennis. Suggested use of the other two courts: basketball, shuffleboard, and /or tennis practice area. Most people want to hire someone to maintain the courts. Several people mentioned that the tennis courts reflect on our property values. Several people would like to get together with other CMA tennis players.

OTHER: (About the empty field behind the pool:) Most respondents would not use a ball field. Suggested uses of the area: garden or nature preserve, volleyball, croquet, badminton, other games.

Several people would like more square dances.

If you have an opinion or an idea to add, contact Recreation Committee Chair Marie Barrett!

(PRESIDENT'S COLUMN Con't.)

As important as are our accomplishments during the past year are the things that remain to be done. At the August meeting of the board of directors a consensus was achieved with regard to our goals for the coming year. They are:

- To preserve and protect our common lands and the environmental values that brought us here.
- To continue to maintain and upgrade our water and road systems;
- To complete the long term study of our road requirements and to begin the first stage of a re-paving and water runoff control program;
- To address the problem of rehabilitating the tennis courts;
- To review our security agreement with Coolfont and assure that we are getting our money's worth;
- To do a comprehensive study of the aquifer on which we depend for water ; and
- To maintain our vigil of the adjoining lands and any development that may affect us.

I am very pleased with the good working relationship that exists among my colleagues on the board of directors and with the spirit of neighborliness among the entire community. We have a great place to live and recreate and we on the board will do our best to keep it that way.

Richard F. Kaufman

THE WATER PAGE

WATER CONSERVATION UPDATE:
Spring and Summer Drought
Lowers Reservoir and Aquifer Levels Across Region

By Jackson Bain

According to CMA's water experts, our community's water supply is still in good shape this summer, despite a region-wide drought that has lowered the levels of aquifers and reservoirs across the area.

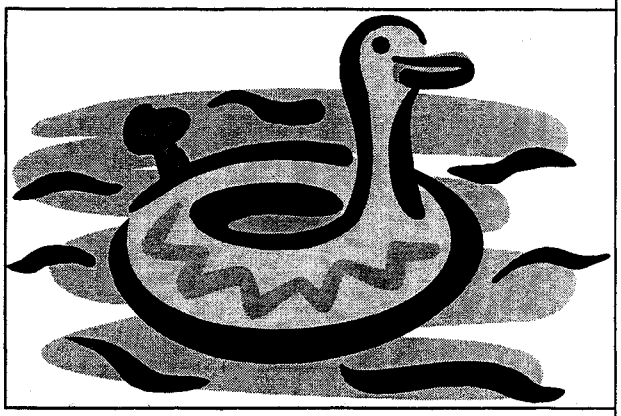
For example, Town of Bath officials are concerned about a significant decrease in the flow of the primary springs that provide water to the town and the important tourist facilities at the baths.

With no end in sight for the drought, CMA homeowners should take steps now to conserve our most vital natural resource wherever possible. For example, regularly check your home for leaky fixtures, turn off water at the entrance pipe when not occupying the home, wash dishes and clothes only when you have a full load, install low-flush toilets, take showers using as little water as possible.
As shown below, we have a limited supply of water; without it, our community would not exist!

Editor's Note: Our community is managed by volunteers. Every service and utility we enjoy on the mountainside is there because of the dedication of hundreds of hours of time by your neighbors. When you turn on your kitchen or bathroom water, do you consider where it comes from, or why it is pure and safe? We have asked some of our volunteers to fill in these blanks for us, giving us all (especially our newer neighbors), a real-world picture of these critically important parts of our community. Board member and CMA's state-registered Water Operator, Elmer Broxson is first on our list!

A Sketch of the CMA Water System

By Elmer Broxson



The CMA is served by two water systems, each with its well and reservoirs. The North Well fills the North Reservoir (located where the K and Q sections meet on Bobcat Drive) which, in turn, fills our highest reservoir, the R Reservoir. The North system serves sections Q, R, S, P and much of K. At the other end of the Association property, the Salmon Well pumps water to the Weinberger Reservoir which serves the rest of the community. This reservoir was named after the engineer and former CMA president who oversaw our 1996 water system upgrade.

Our sewage system is of unusual design. It is a three-stage system consisting of two septic tanks at each house, a 3/4 acre lagoon in the P section and an adjoining constructed wetland. The first septic tank at each home holds the solids (which must be pumped out regularly at the owner's expense). The lagoon dilutes the remaining liquid, and the wetland removes any remaining pollutants. The system's unusual features are the small 4" sewer lines, the second septic tank (actually a siphon chamber needed to scour the small sewage lines), and the constructed wetlands which uses plants, not chemicals, to fully treat the waste water.

As members of the West Virginia Rural Water Association, we receive assistance in solving technical and operating problems and at the annual conference in September, we get a chance to meet officials of our three state regulatory agencies–the health Department, Natural Resources Department, and the Public Service Commission.

COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION
APPROVED BUDGET
2002-2003

	BUDGET 02-03	BUDGET 01-02
Income:		
General Assessment	71,690	68,550
105 HOUSES @ $550 = 57,750		
41 LOTS @ $340 = 13,940		
Rent	1,200	
Expansion Lots	600	600
Late Fees	500	500
Interest	2,000	1,500
Misc Income	100	260
Total Income	**76,090**	**71,410**
Expense:		
POOL Pool Capital	3,200	5,000
Pool System Wages	2,000	2,000
Pool Supplies	3,000	5,000
Lifeguard	5,000	4,000
Office Changing Room	3,000	0
ROADS Roads Capital	14,000	5,000
Road Wages	6,000	5,000
Road Supplies	6,000	6,000
Snow Removal	3,000	5,000
BARN Barn Capital	700	1,000
Barn Wages	700	1,000
Barn Maintenance	700	1,000
SOCIAL	1,300	1,300
MISCELLANEOUS		
Misc Maintenance	1,000	1,000
Misc Operation	500	2,000
Assoc. Business	1,800	2,000
Telephone	400	400
Postage	800	1,000
Electric	1,000	1,000
Security	9,000	9,000
Liability Insurance	3,700	3,500
Legal	1,000	1,000
Operations Management	3,900	3,500
Taxes	3,500	4,000
Board Discretionary Funds	890	1,710
Total Expense	**76,090**	**71,410**
Budget Carry Forward		
Roads Capital	10,000	

**Note: The above budget was approved by the CMA membership at the Annual meeting on July 20, 2002. Due to technical difficulties, this budget replaces the budget sent earlier to members, which contained file and typographical errors. If you have any questions regarding this budget, please contact CMA Treasurer Paul Kagen at (301) 946-0668.*



COOLFONT MOUNTAINSIDE ASSOCIATION
Builders, Contractors, Suppliers and Sources of Materials

General Comments:

The best sources of information about builders, contractors and providers of services are often friends, neighbors and others who live in the Berkeley Springs area or at Coolfont. Those looking for help of one sort or another are advised to ask for recommendations from others in and around the community.

With regard to Berkeley Springs, a good place to inquire is at the Clark's furniture store (2506 Valley Road, (304) 258-2226). Clarks sell household appliances, kitchen cabinets, carpets and flooring materials, etc. Scott Clark, the owner's son, works with many of the builders and can provide names of plumbers, carpenters, tile specialists and the like. There are two hardware stores in Berkeley Springs, and both can also provide good references for service providers: Dawson's (4149 Valley Road, (304) 258-2111) and Hunter's (304 Independence Street, (304) 258-2442.

The following names are based on responses from CMA members to a request for recommendations about persons who have built homes or provided services on the mountainside. There may be others who might also be recommended by our members, but these are the names returned on the survey. If you have additional names, please contact any member of the CMA board or the DACC chair, Jim Thompson. All those listed are in Berkeley Springs unless otherwise indicated.

Builders and General Contractors:

Accent Builders—Bob Diehl, owner	Hancock, MD	258-2781
Berkeley Builders—Don Hoover		258-4050
Custom Homes—John Hobday, Jr.		258-4960
Kenny Johnson	Hancock, MD	(301) 678-7116

Services:

Carpentry - Dale Somers		258-2781
Plumbing and Electrical - Bud Stotler		258-3069
Carpet Cleaning - Mountaineer Carpet Cleaning		258-2074
House Painting - Brian O' Donnell	(cell)	(703) 851-0669
Furniture Moving - Student Services Moving Co.		(703) 849-1888
Pest Control - Erlich Pest Control	Hagerstown, MD	(800) 793-9336
Home Repairs - Barrett's Renovation	Hedgesville, WV	(304) 754-9256



We have some wonderful (and very interesting) homeowners in the Coolfont Mountainside Association. How many have you met? A great way to meet your neighbors is to host a Potluck Dinner, either in your home or in our beautiful barn—weather permitting. It's simple, and a lot of fun. By the way, the number of neighbors who usually attend varies from 12 to about 20!:

How to Host a CMA Potluck Dinner!

In your home:

- Provide plates, cups, napkins and utensils
- Provide ice and soft drinks and coffee - **wine, beer or hard liquor optional**
- Provide dish to share - **completely optional**

In the Barn:

(during the late spring into early fall if you prefer not to host in your home)

- Put provided table cloths on tables set up by John Hobday
- Set out provided plates, cups and utensils that are stored in the Barn
- Provide ice and soft drinks - **wine, beer or hard liquor completely optional**
- Provide dish to share - **completely optional**
- Straighten up area, being sure that all trash is in trash cans
- Fold up table cloths and put back in box, storing in area to rear of Barn
- Let Social Committee Chairs know if any paper supplies, etc. need to be re-supplied (Joan Bradfield or Hallie Kerr)